cocreated the Stuxnet virus that wreaked havoc on Iran's nuclear facilities, causing centrifuges to spin out of control.)

Yet these benefits have not accrued to the Arab communities that send their sons into the army. The Druze have a higher unemployment rate than Jews or Christians, and their villages have historically been underfunded. The same is true of the tiny Circassian community, which numbers about 4,000. Israel's Central Bureau of Statistics generally does not offer a detailed breakdown of socioeconomic data by sect, instead lumping together all of the Arabic-speaking minorities as one population group. A drive around the rutted streets of a crowded Druze village is enough to underscore the lack of investment, however.

At one point the Netanyahu government did make an effort to improve the status of Arab communities, drawing up a 15-billion-shekel plan to improve health care, education, and infrastructure. The cabinet approved the plan, only to freeze it days later after a shooting in Tel Aviv carried out by a single Arab Israeli.

"It's hard to talk about discrimination against Christians, because they are regarded as part of the Arab population," said Sawsan Zaher, a lawyer from Adalah, a legal center for Palestinian rights in Israel. "In education, in housing, in employment, it's overall discrimination against Arabs, Christian or Muslim or Druze. You cannot come and divide between [them]."

Indeed, Khalloul's approach was emblematic of the country's bigger problems. He has carved out another separate identity—not just Arabs, or Christian Arabs, but Aramaic Christians of Arab descent. Jish now has a school, founded in 2008, that teaches in Aramaic, the language used during the time of Christ. A few months after I visited, the interior ministry agreed to recognize "Aramean" as an identity. In October, his 2-year-old son Ya'akov was the first to have it listed on his identity card. "You don't have this in Lebanon, the source of the Maronites," Khalloul said. "And we here in Israel, as they say, the enemy state, they gave us the right to teach our heritage and language. So you see who is the enemy and who is your friend."

The race for the presidency

Ten people have served as the president of Israel, a ceremonial post with a seven-year term. Some use the job to conduct diplomacy and steer the